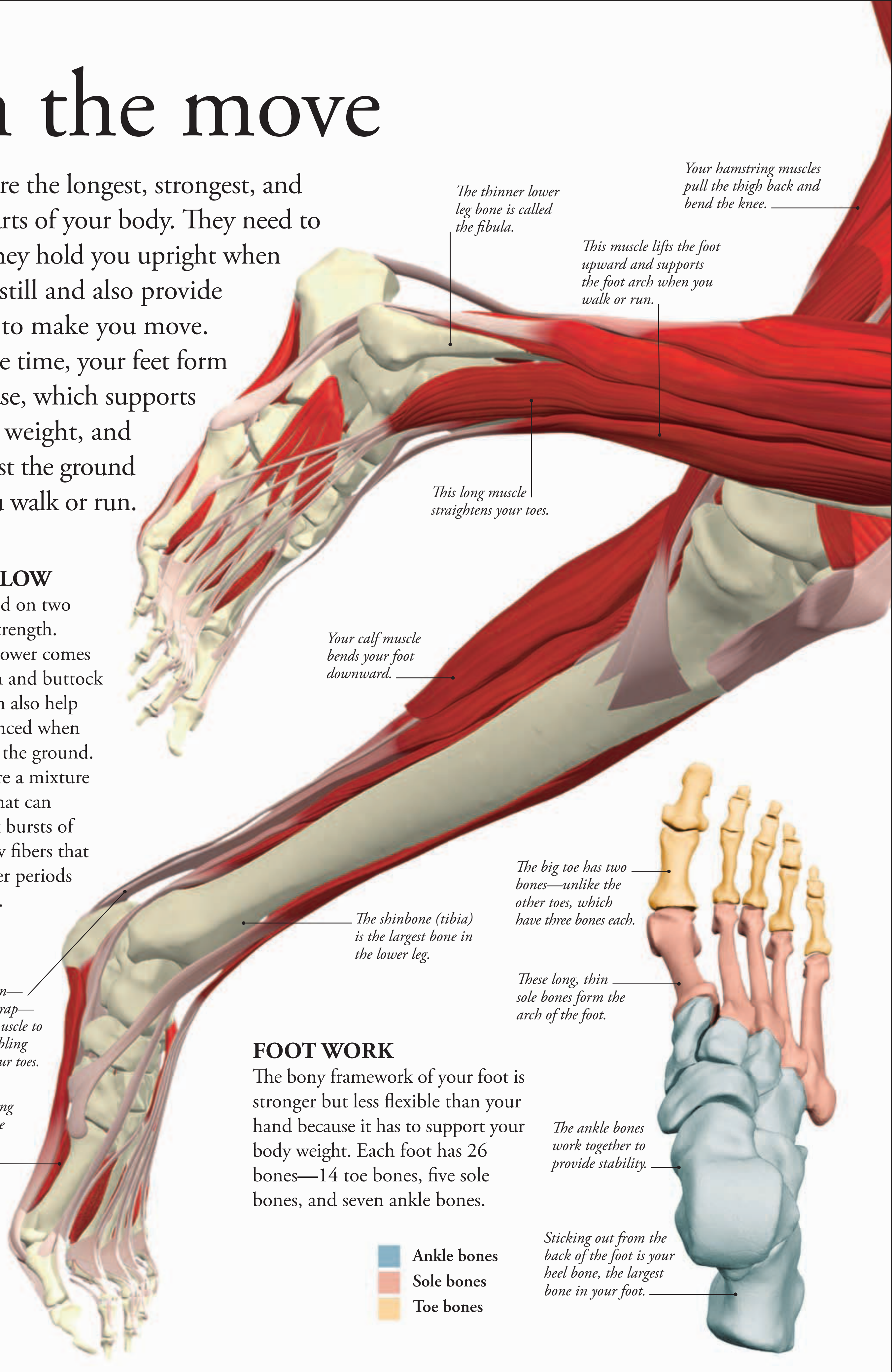
On the move

Your legs are the longest, strongest, and heaviest parts of your body. They need to be, since they hold you upright when you stand still and also provide the power to make you move. At the same time, your feet form a secure base, which supports your body weight, and push against the ground to help you walk or run.



FAST OR SLOW

Moving around on two legs requires strength. Much of the power comes from the thigh and buttock muscles, which also help keep you balanced when one foot is off the ground. Leg muscles are a mixture of fast fibers that can produce quick bursts of speed and slow fibers that work for longer periods without tiring.

FOOT WORK

The bony framework of your foot is stronger but less flexible than your hand because it has to support your body weight. Each foot has 26 bones—14 toe bones, five sole bones, and seven ankle bones.